

ENG 111: Public Speaking

- First Class: Course Introduction & Characteristics of Communication
- Fall 2026
- Today: Get to know the course, one another, and the foundations of communication

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Office Hours:

First Class

- Welcome & introductions — 10 min
- Icebreaker — 10 min
- Course overview — 15 min
- What is communication? — 15 min
- Characteristics of communication — 20 min
- Activity & reflection — 15 min
- Wrap-up — 5 min

Welcome! Let's Start Talking

- Turn to a classmate you do not know well.
- Introduce yourself in about 30 seconds:
 - Your name
 - Your department/major
 - One situation where you feel confident speaking
 - One speaking situation you find challenging

Why Are You Here?

- Think–Pair–Share:
- Why is public speaking important for you?
- Where might you need to speak in public?
- What makes speaking in front of others difficult?

About ENG 111

- Course: Public Speaking
- Prerequisite: ENG 103
- Credit Hours: 3
- The course introduces fundamental principles and practices of rhetoric and the art of public speaking.
- We will focus on persuasion, audience awareness, organization, language, delivery, and supporting materials.

What Will We Practice?

- Informative speaking
- Persuasive speaking
- Impromptu speaking
- Group speech/presentation
- Communication and audience awareness
- Verbal and nonverbal communication
- Listening, interpersonal and group communication

What Should You Be Able to Do?

- Recognize the importance of effective communication
- Develop skills in rhetoric and effective speaking
- Become more confident when addressing an audience
- Understand verbal and nonverbal communication
- Communicate across cultures
- Prepare and deliver effective presentations
- Construct, critique, and analyze different types of speeches

How Will You Be Assessed?

- Exams (Mid and Final average): (15+15=30)
- Attendance: 5
- Class participation: 5
- Quizzes: 10
- Speeches: 50 (Impromptu: 10 +Informative: 15+ Persuasive: 15)
- Group speech/presentation: 10

Our Learning Community

- Respectful, open communication
- Questions are appreciated
- Listen when others are speaking
- Participate actively in discussions
- Help create a healthy learning atmosphere
- Come prepared and arrive on time

What Is Communication?

- Before we define it, discuss:
- Can communication happen without words?
- Can a person communicate without intending to?
- Is communication always successful?
- Write down one example from everyday life.

Communication: A Working Idea

- Communication involves creating and sharing meaning.
- It can involve verbal and nonverbal messages.
- It occurs between people in particular situations and contexts.
- Effective communication requires attention to both the message and the audience.

The Communication Process

- Source/Sender → Message → Channel → Receiver
- The receiver interprets the message.
- Feedback shapes the continuing interaction.
- Noise can interfere with understanding.
- Context influences meaning.
- Question: Where can misunderstanding occur?

Characteristic 1: Communication Is a Process

- Communication develops over time.
- It is not simply a one-way act of sending information.
- Messages and responses influence what happens next.
- Example: A classroom discussion changes as participants respond to one another.

Characteristic 2: Communication Is Continuous

- We communicate through words, tone, facial expressions, posture, silence, and other behaviours.
- Even when we are not speaking, others may interpret our behaviour.
- Question: What might silence communicate in different situations?

Characteristic 3: Communication Is Contextual

- Meaning depends on the situation.
- Consider the same words spoken:
 - To a friend
 - To a teacher
 - During a job interview
 - In front of a large audience
- Audience, purpose, culture, place, and occasion matter.

Characteristic 4: Communication Is Irreversible

- Once a message has been communicated, it cannot be completely taken back.
- We may apologize, clarify, or repair misunderstandings.
- However, the original message may still affect others.
- Public speakers therefore need to think carefully about language and delivery.

Characteristic 5: Communication Requires Adaptation

- Effective communicators consider:
 - Who is my audience?
 - What do they already know?
 - What do they need?
 - What is my purpose?
 - What language and examples are appropriate?

Activity: Same Message, Different Audience

- In pairs, prepare ONE message: “Regular exercise is important.”
- Explain it to:
 - 1. A close friend
 - 2. Your university classmates
 - 3. A group of senior citizens
- How would your language, examples, tone, and delivery change?

Debrief: What Did You Notice?

- Discuss:
- What changed when the audience changed?
- Which communication characteristics appeared in your examples?
- Why is audience awareness essential for public speaking?

Exit Ticket

- Before you leave, write briefly:
- 1. One thing I learned today
- 2. One communication skill I want to improve
- 3. One question I still have about public speaking
- Bring your ideas to our next class.

Looking Ahead

- Next topic: Ethics and Public Speaking
- Please come prepared to discuss the responsibilities of a speaker.
- Remember: Public speaking is a skill developed through knowledge, practice, feedback, and reflection.
- Thank you!